

Rules, Policy & Equity Subcommittee Meeting Notes - April 7, 2021

Chair Paul Ruseau - calls meeting to order - 3:58 PM

Roll Call - Member Van der Kloot - for Member McLaughlin, Member Graham and Member Ruseau - 3-0

Member Ruseau - potential change to SC agenda for regular meetings - saw other communities agendas and liked them a lot - modifying the agenda over time, so that adjustments can be made as needed

Member Graham - makes sense - recommend a few changes, implement them, and ask for feedback - and then add more maybe when school starts again in August

Member Ruseau - format of the agenda - a nice addition when attendance is taken, student rep attendance should be taken - Members first and then the student representative and record it that way

Member Graham - makes sense - actively asking their opinion and taking their vote - report of the secretary - maybe add in a report of student rep - intentionally give them space on the agenda

Member Van der Kloot - SC roll is called and announced by the Mayor - then the student rep announced - I do have some concerns about expanding the student rep responsibilities - keep it a true learning experience - not to put a student potentially on the hot seat

Member Ruseau - the separate attendance - why add another layer? Just do attendance all at once

Member Van der Kloot - often the Mayor announces the student rep

Member Graham - I was just asking the secretary to call them too - don't have to change the agenda

Member Van der Kloot - but they are not part of the quorum

Member Graham - but I never know if the student rep is there

Mr. Murphy - when meeting in person, do you still do a roll call?

Member Van der Kloot - yes

Mr. Murphy - what about the students?

Member Van der Kloot - the Mayor announces them

Mr. Murphy - having an advisor for these students or liaison from the SC would be a great idea

Member Ruseau - student reps are on top of things at least this year - we don't want to indicate if a student is absent - it seemed procedurally easy to have the student's added

Member Van der Kloot - I'd want a separation so it is noted that they are not voting members, but let's move on

Suzi - every roll call? Or just attendance?

Member Ruseau - Just attendance - not sure about student's voting on issues that's a larger issue that Howard might have to be included in that discussion at another time
Any other ideas?

Member Graham - I'd like to move the transfer of funds, and SC regular meeting notes, should be moved to end of the agenda - the public isn't interested really

Member Ruseau - Ms. Presser didn't seem to think that would be weird - consent agenda - I would agree to move it

Member Van der Kloot - I look at it as the "warm up" - I do have question about the report of the Secretary - I don't know if it would make sense to maybe take that out - different secretary's handle it different ways - for example, Kathy might highlight a particular bill - but it's a rare need - even letters come in now as community participation

Member Ruseau - I'm fine with removing the secretary's report

Member Van der Kloot - secretary's report should be moved to community participation - for any emails/letters

Member Ruseau - for community participation, have the Mayor explain our rules, prior to listening to community participation

Member Graham - have the public learn the role of public comment in our meetings - topics need to be posted - so answers can't always be addressed - What is the role of public comment? Have

a clear policy of how long you may speak, how many times you can speak, what you can and cannot do as part of public comment and what SC can and can't do with public comment

Motion to remove Sec report

Sec report moved under community participation - sec report a bullet under community participation

Roll Call - 3-0

Member Ruseau - consent agenda concept?

Member Van der Kloot - What do you mean?

Member Ruseau - Consent on the agenda, list the minutes, bills & payrolls - (1) roll call for all

Member Van der Kloot - It's fine for minutes - not sure about bills, payrolls - I'd want clarification for that

Member Ruseau - items that are allowed for a consent agenda to combine them and put it at the end of the agenda? Personally, I think it's fine - and I get the warm up

Member Graham - Looking at SC agenda from other communities - consent agenda online do include warrants

Member Van der Kloot - could you send me the link?

Member Ruseau - Consent agenda moved to end of agenda

Roll Call - 3-0

Member Ruseau - attendance - should we send a recommendation for the student reps to be included in the attendance of the regular SC meeting - can we move it forward to the main meeting?

Roll - 3-0

Member Van der Kloot - has to leave now - 4:38 PM

Member Ruseau - policy on harassment ACAB

Member Graham - little surprised that employee to student harassment - is there a legal reason for that? Student to student harassment seems like it should be added to the student employee harassment as well

Mr. Murphy - there are laws governing participating in sports Prohibition on harassment - it can be broad for a reason - we certainly would hold staff accountable on harassment - for inappropriate communications -

Member Graham - I was surprised when I was onboarded

Member Ruseau - do we even have employee to employee harassment? I don't see it at all - which happens all the time -

Member Ruseau - I'm going to move onto the staff conduct - GBEB

Suzi - not in the posting, only in the folder for this meeting

Member Ruseau - Motion to approve by Member Graham, Member Ruseau - 2nd

Roll Call - 2 present - 1 absent - motion is approved for Apr 12th agenda

Member Ruseau - back to the Harassment Policy -

Member Graham - idk the name of this policy? I think it speaks more to student harassment rather than employee to employee harassment - maybe the name of policy has to change?

Member Ruseau - we can change the name

Member Graham - is the intent of the policy just for students? We need to be clear - or this our one and only harassment policy

Dr. Cushing - it is one policy - I can check with MASC - my suggestion is to recommend this as a 1st reading - so SC can digest it and add if necessary

Member Ruseau - checking with MASC for other harassment policies - I don't see anything else listed - Maybe we should check with our attorney?

Member Ruseau - I'm drafting a new set of rules, with 2nd readings of policies - I don't think why we can't discuss it on the floor and then have it tabled until next meeting

Member Graham - who is our Title 9 person?

Dr. Cushing - Ms. Bowen - the rules are being changed under the Biden administration, who is making changes from the previous administration

Member Ruseau - I remember when the changes came out under the previous administration
We probably should have invited Howard to this meeting. It sounds like staff is already going through training under the previous administration's rules, and I know the policy will be changed shortly under the new administration - so would you have to attend additional different trainings

Ms. Bowen - there is a lot in here